

JARROD TRAN

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SUMMARY

AI enablement and factory-strategy leader. Builds teams and systems that turn new technology into cost, capacity, and productivity results. Tesla Energy, Waymo, Apple.

EXPERIENCE

Lead, AI Enablement & Factory Strategy

Aug 2023 – Present

Tesla · Houston, TX

- Define and lead the AI enablement strategy for Tesla Energy Manufacturing: roadmap, operating model, governance, workforce enablement, and executive reporting across Megapack, Powerwall, battery cell/LFP, Supercharger, and Solar.
- Built and lead a forward-deployed AI engineering organization spanning product management and embedded engineering. 1,000+ active users and 20+ production AI solutions, including RAG troubleshooting, automated reporting, workflow automation, and decision-support.
- Established an AI productivity framework modeled at about 540 reclaimed hours per week and \$1.6M in annualized value, with MCP-based automation as additional upside.
- Own factory strategy and production planning for Megapack across California, Texas, and Shanghai. Scaled production 3.2x, from 14.7 GWh to 46.7 GWh, and built the capacity roadmap to 130+ GWh.
- Directed a \$23M capacity investment portfolio across 50+ initiatives, generating \$156M in incremental annual profit. Separately delivered \$260M in annualized cost savings through NPI and manufacturing cost-down.
- Developed manufacturing and supply-chain strategies protecting against \$550M in projected tariff exposure, then built and promoted successors so day-to-day factory strategy could run without me.

Strategy & Operations Manager

Oct 2022 – May 2023

Waymo · Mountain View, CA

- Led annual planning, OKRs, and quarterly business reviews for Engineering Operations in a safety-critical autonomous-vehicle environment.
- Built leadership dashboards and ran cross-functional work across hardware, software, fleet, Product, Legal, and Engineering, including safety and regulatory requirements for commercial deployment.

Strategic Operations Program Manager

Jun 2021 – Jun 2022

Apple · Cupertino, CA

- Scaled global iPhone operations 293% year over year, from 4.3M to 16.9M units, and supported program revenue growth from \$2B to \$10B by turning demand into capacity and supplier-readiness plans.
- Led Apple's iPhone manufacturing launch in India from inception through mass production, and expanded India-manufactured exports from 6 to 40+ countries.

Program Manager, Special Projects

Jun 2018 – Jun 2021

Tesla · Fremont, CA

- Managed Project Roadrunner, Tesla's 4680 battery-cell program, from early pilot to a production-ready platform heading into Battery Day.
- Designed and launched a \$3.5M-per-month mobile logistics platform, Warehouse on Wheels, and led production planning and recovery across Model 3 and Model Y.

EDUCATION

University at Buffalo · B.S. Business Administration, Finance · Cum Laude

EXPERTISE

AI Enablement · Factory & Capacity Strategy · Forward-Deployed Engineering · NPI · Cost Transformation · Global Operations · Workforce Planning · Cross-Functional Leadership